

URBAN GREEN COVER AND CONSTRUCTION ENVIRONMENTAL RULES, 2026 (ILLUSTRATIVE)

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1. Applicability

1.1 These Rules apply to any construction project with a built-up area exceeding 500 square metres within municipal limits. 1.2 Projects below this threshold are exempt from Sections 3 and 4 but remain subject to Section 5.

2. Tree Protection

2.1 No tree with a girth of 30 cm or more measured at chest height shall be felled without prior permission from the Tree Authority. 2.2 For every tree felled with permission, the applicant must plant 3 replacement saplings and maintain them for a minimum of 3 years.

3. Mandatory Green Cover

3.1 Every approved construction project above the threshold in Section 1.1 must reserve at least 15% of the plot area as green cover. 3.2 Green cover requirements may be met up to 40% through vertical gardens or terrace plantation where ground-level space is insufficient.

4. Environmental Clearance Timelines

4.1 An application for environmental clearance must be processed within 60 days of submission. 4.2 If no decision is communicated within 90 days, the clearance shall be deemed granted subject to standard conditions.

5. Dust and Emission Control

5.1 Construction sites must install anti-smog guns or equivalent dust-suppression systems if the site exceeds 2,000 square metres. 5.2 Any site found operating without dust control measures during a declared high-pollution period shall face work stoppage for up to 7 days.

6. Penalties

6.1 Unauthorised felling under Section 2.1 shall attract a fine of Rs. 20,000 per tree in addition to the replacement planting obligation. 6.2 Failure to maintain the green cover ratio under Section 3.1 at the time of occupancy certificate inspection shall result in withholding of the certificate until compliance.